

## THE REHAB OF RAHAB

**TEXT:** Joshua 2:1-14-21 (NKJV) *“Now Joshua the son of Nun sent out two men from Acacia Grove to spy secretly, saying, “Go, view the land, especially Jericho. So they went, and came to the house of a harlot named Rahab, and lodged there. <sup>2</sup> And it was told the king of Jericho, saying, “Behold, men have come here tonight from the children of Israel to search out the country.” <sup>3</sup> So the king of Jericho sent to Rahab, saying, “Bring out the men who have come to you, who have entered your house, for they have come to search out all the country.” <sup>4</sup> Then the woman took the two men and hid them. So she said, “Yes, the men came to me, but I did not know where they were from. <sup>5</sup> And it happened as the gate was being shut, when it was dark, that the men went out. Where the men went I do not know; pursue them quickly, for you may overtake them.” <sup>6</sup> (But she had brought them*

*up to the roof and hidden them with the stalks of flax, which she had laid in order on the roof.)<sup>7</sup> Then the men pursued them by the road to the Jordan, to the fords. And as soon as those who pursued them had gone out, they shut the gate.<sup>8</sup> Now before they lay down, she came up to them on the roof,<sup>9</sup> and said to the men: "I know that the Lord has given you the land, that the terror of you has fallen on us, and that all the inhabitants of the land are fainthearted because of you."<sup>10</sup> For we have heard how the Lord dried up the water of the Red Sea for you when you came out of Egypt, and what you did to the two kings of the Amorites who were on the other side of the Jordan, Sihon and Og, whom you utterly destroyed.<sup>11</sup> And as soon as we heard these things, our hearts melted; neither did there remain any more courage in anyone because of you, for the Lord your God, He is God in heaven above and on earth beneath.<sup>12</sup> Now therefore, I beg you, swear to me by the Lord, since I have shown you kindness, that you also*

*will show kindness to my father's house, and give me a true token,<sup>13</sup> and spare my father, my mother, my brothers, my sisters, and all that they have, and deliver our lives from death.”<sup>14</sup> So the men answered her, “Our lives for yours, if none of you tell this business of ours. And it shall be, when the Lord has given us the land, that we will deal kindly and truly with you.”<sup>15</sup> Then she let them down by a rope through the window, for her house was on the city wall; she dwelt on the wall.<sup>16</sup> And she said to them, “Get to the mountain, lest the pursuers meet you. Hide there three days, until the pursuers have returned. Afterward you may go your way.”<sup>17</sup> So the men said to her: “We will be blameless of this oath of yours which you have made us swear, unless, when we come into the land, you bind this line of scarlet cord in the window through which you let us down, and unless you bring your father, your mother, your brothers, and all your father's household to your own home.<sup>19</sup> So it shall be that whoever goes outside the doors of*

*your house into the street, his blood shall be on his own head, and we will be guiltless. And whoever is with you in the house, his blood shall be on our head if a hand is laid on him.<sup>20</sup> And if you tell this business of ours, then we will be free from your oath which you made us swear.”<sup>21</sup> Then she said, “According to your words, so be it.” And she sent them away, and they departed. And she bound the scarlet cord in the window.”*

**INTRO:** This passage of Scripture is one of the greatest seed plots in the Word of God. In preaching terms, a preacher can go almost any direction from this passage.

The direction I have chosen this morning is to paint a picture of how the Lord can take a life that is messed up and do a makeover (Rehab).

When He is allowed to do this, He always turns a predetermined disaster into a beautiful picture

of His grace. He has done just that in most of our lives has He not? (Think of where you were when He found you - And where you are today!)

(Put up the pictures of the two cabins we recently rehabbed in Arkansas) (Talk about how a makeover is really a do-over – A second chance)

The rehab of Rahab is the story of a transformed woman. If there ever was a story of a makeover, it is the story of Rahab:

- She was a pagan...
- She was a resident of Jericho...
- She was a Canaanite...
- She was a prostitute...

Rahab was not only a Canaanite living in Jericho, she was living on the edge of society. Her house was built into the city wall.

Because of the proximity of Rahab's house to the edge of the city, it was a natural place for the Israelite spies to stay when Joshua sent them in to spy on the city. (Talk about the spies staying with a prostitute)

Her house was not only a great hideout because of how easy it would be to escape over the city wall, but everyone would assume the spies were just Rahab's customers. (So would the church!!! I mean the Israelites!!!)

## **THE REHAB OF RAHAB REQUIRED RISK-TAKING**

Any makeover is risky business:

- It is risky because of the cost...
- It is risky because of the effort...
- It is risky because it changes the appearance of a thing...
- It is risky because a new look will emerge...

Rahab was sick and tired of her old life and decided to take the risk. She hid the spies. The

risk she was taking was great! If it were to be discovered that she was colluding with the spies, she would surely be put to death, and her family would no doubt be killed too.

What are we willing to risk to rehab the Rahab in our lives? (Are we willing to face down – Carnal members? You are the Pastor Bro! Board members? The news media? Etc...)

In the times that we are living in, if you are going to play it safe you are going to fail!

God is looking for some Holy risk-takers to step from the shadows and:

- Step up...
- Stand up...
- Speak up...

And shut the devil up!

We only know about the three Hebrew Children because they defied the King's commandment!

## THE REHAB OF RAHAB REQUIRED FAITH

Rahab knew the Israelites relied on a God worth trusting. The stories about the Israelites had been circulating for years. Israel was about to invade. She did not let her fear affect her faith!

The rehab of Rahab required faith in God's ability to deliver. Joshua 2:8-14 (NKJV) *"I know that the Lord has given you the land, that the terror of you has fallen on us, and that all the inhabitants of the land are fainthearted because of you. <sup>10</sup> For we have heard how the Lord dried up the water of the Red Sea for you when you came out of Egypt, and what you did to the two kings of the Amorites who were on the other side of the Jordan, Sihon and Og, whom you utterly destroyed. <sup>11</sup> And as soon as we heard these things, our hearts melted; neither did there remain any more courage in anyone because of you, for the Lord your God, He is God in heaven above and on earth beneath. <sup>12</sup> Now*

*therefore, I beg you, swear to me by the Lord, since I have shown you kindness, that you also will show kindness to my father's house, and give me a true token, <sup>13</sup> and spare my father, my mother, my brothers, my sisters, and all that they have, and deliver our lives from death."* Rahab had more faith than most of the Pentecostal Pastors, I mean Israelites!

This is going to sound strange indeed – Rahab's rehab (Makeover) was predicated on her faith! The faith of a prostitute saved her family! What could the faith of some Spirit filled preachers do?

## **THE REHAB OF RAHAB AFFECTED EVERYONE IN PROXIMITY**

We should always remember that one persons faith can have a huge impact on the lives of others. Rahab's faith effectively saved her entire family from destruction.

How many times has this very thing been repeated in history? One person's faith and salvation change's a family line! I believe in household salvation! (Nobody goes to hell from this house! Not one person will perish from my family line EVER!)

Rahab's new life with the Jews gave her family a chance to know about God, and for their lives to be transformed as Rahab's was. God is in the business of saving even the worst sinners – To most people Rahab was a nothing, but to God, her soul was valuable.

When whole families get affected by someone's rehabilitation, it normally starts with one person believing. (My dad's family)

Who is that one person that you want to see saved? Don't give up on them. God can save anyone no matter what they have done or how disinterested they seem to be. Never let a person's background, lifestyle, or appearance

get in your way of telling them about Jesus and believing for their salvation.

## **THE REHAB OF RAHAB PRODUCED MORE THAN SHE HAD PLANNED FOR HERSELF**

Rahab didn't have much planned for herself! Look how this story of Transformation ends! When Rahab placed her bet on the winning team:

- God gave her the lives of her family...  
Joshua 6:23 (NKJV) *“And the young men who had been spies went in and brought out Rahab, her father, her mother, her brothers, and all that she had. So they brought out all her relatives and left them outside the camp of Israel.”*
- She married and assimilated into the nation of Israel...
- She married an Israeli man by the name of Salmon...

- She became the mother of Boaz... Matthew 1:5 (NKJV) “*Salmon begot Boaz by Rahab...*”
- She became the great-great grandmother of King David...
- She became an ancestor of Jesus... (30 generations from the time Rahab came out of Jericho, Jesus was born into the lineage of a former prostitute)
- She is one of only two women listed in the Faith Hall of Fame in Hebrews 11...

Man and woman of God... God has more planned for us and our ministries than we have planned for ourselves! In order to receive what He has planned for us we must shut out the voices around us and place our bets on the King and the Kingdom!

## **CONCLUSION:**

And that, my friends... Is the rehab of Rahab –

What is our rehab going to look like?

What is our rehab going to accomplish in our family lines?

What is our rehab going to produce in the Kingdom?

What affect will our rehab produce in the world?